# Brand Position: RudCo Quote Desk

**Status:** Approved by Ken, 2026-10-10. The look lives in the style guide, also approved.

**Read with:** the product brief, the demo workflow, the RudCo profile, the competitive analysis, the sharper-angle report.

**Summary.** We present the product as a RudCo tool for its quoting reps. The name is RudCo Quote Desk. It looks like part of rud-co.com: RudCo's navy, its bright blue for actions, its system sans type, and its own logo files, unchanged. The message is one idea: every line on the quote shows where it came from. The pitch line is the brief's: the agent prepares the conversation, and the rep owns it. Every claim we make maps to a line RudCo has written itself (alignment table). It is written as if it runs on RudCo's real catalog, inventory and prices.

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## Where the product story lives

Section 1

This document is about how we talk: voice, words and taglines. How it looks is in the style guide. What we build, for whom, the value props, and how it differs from competitors live in the product brief: see Who it is for, The job to be done, and How it is different.

## How this aligns with RudCo's brand

Section 2

Each claim we make, and each tagline, maps to one of RudCo's own lines. The anchor list is the "In their own words" section of the RudCo profile. I checked every quote below against its linked page today.

| Our claim or tagline | Their line | Source |
|---|---|---|
| Every field shows the RFQ words and the rule it came from. | "Supply chains and distribution are really about data and how that data is managed" | Digital Journal |
| Each line carries price, benchmark, lead time and paperwork, so the buyer can decide on one page. | "A buyer needs to understand pricing, supply, inventory, and transportation well enough to make a sound decision quickly." | Digital Journal |
| The rep approves and sends every quote. The buyer hears from a person. | "People still want to deal with people, especially when the decision is important" | Digital Journal |
| Pitch line: the agent prepares the conversation, and the rep owns it. Unclear lines are automatically resolved with the buyer. | "Technology can handle more of the coordination and give those people better information for the conversation." | Digital Journal |
| Every price sits beside a named benchmark with a one-sentence reason. Tagline 1: "Every line shows its work." | "Opacity is a tax on industrial procurement." | LinkedIn, 2026-04-20 |
| Every benchmark carries its date. A line with no benchmark is held, not priced. Tagline 3: "A price with its date and its source." | "The market moves every day. The quote in your inbox often doesn't." | LinkedIn, 2026-05-11 |

| Our claim or tagline | Their line | Source |
|---|---|---|
| A messy email in, a quote on RudCo's own lines (steel shot, aluminum ingot, plate) out. | "Industrial materials simplified." | site code |
| Accurate reading, an open price, and a person who signs off. Tagline 2: "Read right. Priced in the open. Sent by your rep." | "Precision. Transparency. Trust." | site code |
| Compliance flags for MTR, COA, origin, DFARS, REACH and RoHS. | "PO→COA/MTR" and "DFARS/REACH/RoHS flags" (site FAQ copy, outside the profile's quote list) | site code |
| The name Quote Desk: the rep's desk, where the quote is prepared before the conversation. | "People still want to deal with people" and technology gives them "better information for the conversation" | Digital Journal |
| Lead time on stocked lines; a quote draft well inside their reply window. | "Stocked lines ship in 24–48 hours" and a quote reply "within 24 hours" (site copy) | site code |

**The one claim with no anchor.** The comparison with other quote tools has no line behind it: RudCo does not position itself against competitors in its own words. So the comparison stays as evidence for judges in How it is different in the brief. No headline, tagline or UI copy rests on it.

## Claims we make, and claims we don't

Section 3

**Price claims.** We never say RudCo is cheapest. Every price explanation says the price tracks published metal cost plus RudCo's margin (WORKFLOW step 5).

**We learn the buyer.** It is how we beat competitors on their own claim. Proton and Canals say they learn customers' shorthand. Ours shows where each learned reading came from: "Read as 0.060 in, as you confirmed on RFQ-0001" (workflow step 9, competitive analysis).

**What we do not claim.** We do not imply credit terms, cutting, or ERP links. Lead times come from RudCo's inventory: stocked lines ship in 24 to 48 hours, and anything else says "to confirm". The demo covers quote preparation only (competitive analysis).

## Voice and messaging

Section 4

### RudCo's voice, as it appears

- **Short, declarative lines.** "Industrial materials simplified." and "Precision. Transparency. Trust." (site code).
- **Names the cost of hiding things.** "Opacity is a tax on industrial procurement." and "The cost doesn’t show up as price. It shows up as friction." (LinkedIn).
- **Speaks to the buyer's doubt.** "The market moves every day. The quote in your inbox often doesn't." (LinkedIn).
- **Keeps people central.** "People still want to deal with people, especially when the decision is important" (Digital Journal).
- **Plain buttons.** The site's most common button labels are "Request a Quote" and "Contact Us" (site code).

## Tagline options

Each sits under "Precision. Transparency. Trust."

1. **Every line shows its work.** (Recommended. It is the product in five words, and it answers "Opacity is a tax on industrial procurement.")
2. **Read right. Priced in the open. Sent by your rep.** (One phrase for each word of "Precision. Transparency. Trust.")
3. **A price with its date and its source.** (Answers "The market moves every day. The quote in your inbox often doesn't.")

**Pitch line** (from the brief): "The agent prepares the conversation, and the rep owns it." It restates the founder's "better information for the conversation" in our terms. Use it to close the video, as WORKFLOW says.

## Words to use and avoid

| Use | Avoid |
| --- | --- |
| quote, line, RFQ, buyer, rep | "AI-powered", "autonomous", "magic" |
| read as, matched to, priced against | "cheapest", "lowest price", "best price" |
| benchmark, dated, published metal cost plus RudCo's margin | "real-time" or "live" pricing (benchmarks are dated, not live) |
| compliance, compliance flag, mill test report (MTR), certificate of analysis (COA), country of origin, DFARS, REACH, RoHS | "certified" (we flag what the buyer needs; we do not certify stock) |
| lead time, in stock, ships in 24 to 48 hours (stocked lines), to confirm | |
| ask, question, needs the buyer, the conversation | "replaces your rep", "hands-free" |
| inventory, stocked | "instant", "guaranteed" |

### Sample UI microcopy

The SKU, benchmark and prices below are placeholders. The screen fills them from RudCo's catalog, inventory and benchmarks.

- **Ready line:** "Ready. Read as 304 stainless sheet, 0.0625 in (16 ga, stainless gauge table), 48 x 96 in. Matched to SKU [SKU]. Price tracks [benchmark name, date] plus RudCo's margin. Lead time: 24 to 48 hours (in stock)."
- **Lead time not known:** "Lead time: to confirm. This item is not in stock."

- **Needs-the-buyer line:** "Needs the buyer. Line 3 says 16 gauge and 0.060 in. Those are different thicknesses. Question drafted."
- **Compliance flag:** "Mill test report needed. Triggered by "SA-240" in line 4, an ASME pressure-vessel spec."
- **COA flag:** "Certificate of analysis needed. Triggered by "COA required" in the email body. Applies to lines 2 and 3."
- **REACH / RoHS flag:** "REACH and RoHS declarations requested. Triggered by "REACH/RoHS compliant" in the attachment, page 1."
- **Context flag:** "DFARS origin rules may apply. Triggered by the ship-to address, not the line. Confirm with the buyer."
- **No match:** "No match. Nothing in RudCo's catalog fits this line. Not priced."
- **Buyer question email, subject:** "RFQ-0001, line 3: 16 gauge or 0.060 in?"
- **Buyer question email, opening line:** "Thanks for your RFQ. Lines 1 and 2 are priced. Before we quote line 3, one question: do you need 16 gauge (0.0625 in) or exactly 0.060 in? Click the one you need below."

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## Visual identity

Section 5

The look (palette, status colors, type, buttons, layout and logo use) lives in the style guide.

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## Honesty guardrails

Section 6

- **No customers.** RudCo names no customer in public (RudCo profile). The sample buyer stays fictional (Northline Fabrication, per the frontend contract).

- **Flags, not certificates.** A compliance flag records what the buyer needs. It does not certify RudCo's material (frontend contract).
- **Quotes stay exact.** Any RudCo line used in the pitch is quoted word for word from its linked page.

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## Sources

Section 7


**RudCo, read directly on 2026-10-10**

- rud-co.com home page HTML (theme-color, asset links)
- Site stylesheet, index-A39G_5VS.css (`:root` tokens, radius, fonts)
- Site script, index-B04wKX3n.js (header, footer, buttons, copy)
- Home share image, og/home.png (navy and gold samples)
- Logo files: header mark, footer mark
- LinkedIn posts: post on opacity as a tax, post on getting the right rate, post on email procurement
- Digital Journal interview with the founder, 2026-08-21

**Our docs**

- PRD, WORKFLOW, frontend contract, UI/UX approach
- RudCo profile, competitive analysis, sharper-angle report
- brand_colors.py: HSL to hex, share-image sampling, contrast ratios

**Name searches, 2026-10-10**

- Quote Desk: G2 CPQ listing, pickyourapp, Quote Desk
- Open Quote: OpenQuote 1.0 release note
- ClearQuote: CB Insights, Justia, PGT Industries trademarks

- Line Check: no product found; results were general RFQ pages such as alcircle

**Others cited**

- Get Hired Hack on Devpost
- Precision Steel Services estimator posting
- Cassidy, Proton, Central Steel & Wire FAQ, Yarde, N.T. Ruddock, Winoa